

Chicago Tribune



QUESTIONS? CALL 1-800-TRIBUNE

TUESDAY, APRIL 8, 2025

BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Trump threatens new China tariffs

US markets careen as uncertainty over trade stokes worries

By **Chris Megerian**
and **Josh Boak**
Associated Press

WASHINGTON — Undeterred by a stock market collapse that has continued for days, President Donald Trump threatened additional tariffs on China on Monday, raising fresh concerns that his

drive to rebalance the global economy could intensify a financially destructive trade war. Trump’s threat, which he delivered on social media, came after China said it would retaliate against U.S. tariffs he announced last week. “If China does not withdraw its 34% increase above their already

long term trading abuses by tomorrow, April 8th, 2025, the United States will impose ADDITIONAL Tariffs on China of 50%, effective April 9th,” he wrote on Truth Social. “Additionally, all talks with China concerning their requested meetings with us will be terminated!” If Trump implements his plans,

U.S. tariffs on imports from China would reach a combined 104%. The new taxes would be on top of the 20% tariffs announced as punishment for fentanyl trafficking and his separate 34% tariffs announced last week. Not only could that increase prices for American consumers, it could give China an incentive to flood other countries with cheaper goods and seek deeper partnerships with other trading partners.

Trump faces mounting pressure in the financial markets and from business leaders to back-track on his tariff ambitions, yet he has shown no signs of reversing course or finding a message to calm panicked markets. The White House said Monday that Trump would veto a Senate bill that would mandate congressional approval for new tariffs, a bet that the crit-

Turn to Tariffs, Page 9

Johnson still mired in contract standoff

No agreement with firefighters despite dropping reorganization plan

By **Jake Sheridan**
and **Alice Yin**
Chicago Tribune

When rank-and-file firefighters joined them to demand a contract last month, the Chicago Teachers Union framed the team-up in powerful terms: “Two unions. One fight.” Now, with a pending deal for teachers clinched last week, only one of them remains in the ring.

Chicago Firefighters Union Local 2 is rounding out the fourth year of its battle for a new collective bargaining agreement. Unlike their counterparts in school classrooms, the first responders have gone without the vocal support of Mayor Brandon Johnson throughout their relatively drama-free standoff.

But behind the scenes, sources from both sides of the bargaining table described an impasse in negotiations that has them hurtling toward arbitration. By state law, police officers and firefighters cannot strike.

Local 2 President Pat Cleary said the long wait flies in the face of a mayoral campaign questionnaire statement Johnson gave him in which the then-candidate pledged “No union should go a day without a contract.”

“If he were pro-labor, I would have a contract,” Cleary said.

How Johnson maneuvers through the political and fiscal dilemma of landing the deal will prove fateful to not just his self-claimed brand as “obviously the

Turn to Contract, Page 4

Cubs in dire need of rally animal

Paul Sullivan: After Wrigley Field’s goose flies the coop, the search is on for a new Cubs rally animal.
Chicago Sports

Ulta Beauty pauses Target expansion

Ulta Beauty is pausing expansion of its Target shop-in-shops this year. The plan called for 800 in-store locations.
Business

Tornadoes, heavy rains kill at least 23

Days of unrelenting heavy rain and storms fill rivers to near-record levels across Kentucky, submerging neighborhoods.
Nation & World



EILEEN T. MESLAR/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Quezada joins City Council

Cook County Commissioner Anthony Quezada gets emotional with his siblings Michael Carvajal, from left, and Samantha Carvajal and niece Nora Bradford before Chicago City Council members voted to approve him as 35th Ward alderman during a Rules Committee meeting at City Hall on Monday. **Chicagoland, Page 3**



Resident Aaron Sadowski sits in a room Wednesday at the Gateway Foundation Kedzie Recovery Home, an early recovery and sober living center that is facing funding cuts. **E. JASON WAMBSGANS/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Federal funding cuts, state budget woes leave recovery services scrambling

By **Olivia Olander**
Chicago Tribune

Aaron Sadowski says he knows how to get sober. He just needs help to stay there.

Last year, after getting evicted from an apartment on the near South Side, the 47-year-old found himself homeless for eight months, sleeping on the beach or in cheap hotels and doing whatever it took to afford alcohol and cocaine.

“I could have kept doing that, but I knew that there was no end. It was just a vicious cycle,”

Sadowski said in an interview at the Kedzie Recovery Home, a residential recovery center for men. “I know what to do, but I won’t do it on my own. I need that little bit of prodding.”

The center provides intense therapy and social services as well as a place to live and up to three meals a day for dozens of men who might otherwise have no housing.

But the Humboldt Park home, run by the Chicago-based Gateway Foundation nonprofit, finds itself squeezed by a tight state budget that can’t cover the

hole left by federal funding cuts ordered by the Trump administration.

A \$500,000 federal grant meant to counter the opioid overdose crisis has covered the annual accommodations for 18 of the center’s roughly 70 residents, according to Karolina Strack, Gateway’s government affairs director. That federal funding likely evaporated with Trump’s recent executive order slashing more than \$11 billion in health services nationwide, she said.

Turn to Services, Page 2

Great Lakes basins may be millions of years old

Study: Deep activity may have formed system pre-glaciers

By **Adriana Pérez**
Chicago Tribune

As an ice sheet thousands of feet thick began its final crawling retreat from North America to the Arctic toward the end of the last glacial period some 10,000 years ago, it left behind the planet’s largest freshwater system. At least that’s what scientists have long believed about the formation of the Great Lakes.

But a recent study suggests that the timeline actually stretches further back — beyond the evolution of early humans and past the age of dinosaurs — to 200 million to 300 million years ago when a hot spot, or plume of hot material, from underneath Earth’s crust created a low point that the glaciers would finish carving out and filling with water much later.

“Most of upper North America was covered by glaciation. But why, in this particular area, (are there) these Great Lakes?” said Aibing Li, a seismologist at the University of Houston who co-authored the study, which was published in the sci-

Turn to Great Lakes, Page 4

